
CHE 499

Professional Development Seminar Syllabus

Instructor:

Alan Zdunek

Office: 150 EIB

Email: zdunek@uic.edu**Course Time/Location:**

Friday 2:00-2:50pm

Classroom: On-Campus EIB 124

Introduction:

CHE 499 is a weekly seminar-based course. Invited speakers provide information about graduate school, what industries hire chemical engineers, job-related experience, traditional and non-traditional chemical engineering career paths, and career advice. Career development and job search information is also provided from the Engineering Career Center. Students evaluate their educational experience in the Chemical Engineering Department through a senior exit survey. The course is only open to chemical engineering seniors and must be taken in the Fall semester of the last year of study. CHE 499 is only offered in the Fall semester and is a 0-credit hour course.

Attendance

- CHE 499 will be held on-campus, no hybrid learning, no recorded lectures.
- In-class attendance is mandatory.
- One excused absence is allowed but you must confirm with the instructor before the class period, preferably the day before (Thursday).
- More than 2 unexcused absences will result in an Unsatisfactory grade in the course.

Specific goals for the course

a. Specific outcomes of instruction. Students will:

- Interact with practicing chemical engineers
- Learn about traditional and non-traditional chemical engineering career paths, both in academia and industry
- Learn job searching skills; networking, resume writing, interviewing skills, salary negotiation
- Learn what industries hire chemical engineers
- Learn about their role as UIC Chemical Engineering alumni
- Relate their UIC educational experience in an exit survey
- Complete a written examination on engineering problems, careers, teamwork and ethics

Student Learning Outcomes	1	2	3	4
(3) an ability to communicate effectively with a range of audiences.			X	
(4) an ability to recognize ethical and professional responsibilities in engineering situations and make informed judgments, which must consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and societal contexts.			X	
(7) an ability to acquire and apply new knowledge as needed, using appropriate learning strategies.			X	

Brief list of topics to be covered

- Where chemical engineers work: Chemical engineering-related industries
- Traditional and non-traditional chemical engineering career paths
- Chemical engineering job-related experience
- Career development information: job searching, resume writing, interviewing skills, salary negotiation, networking, alumni contacts.